Venkata Maruthi Sowmyanath Adapala

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Education

University of Toronto — Mississauga, ON
Honours Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — *Sept. 2023 – May 2028*

- Relevant Coursework: System Design, Object Oriented Programming, Web Development

Experience

Software Developer, Empathic AI Agent — September 2026 – Present
CSC398 Research Project, University of Toronto — *Mississauga, ON*

- Collaborating with four developers to build an **empathic AI coaching agent** that detects vague requests and asks **clarifying questions** before answering, using a *FastAPI* backend, *PostgreSQL* session storage, a *React* frontend, and **LLM API** integration
- Set up the project's initial **Docker Compose** environment so all five contributors run identical services
- Designing the project's **evaluation framework**: a labelled dataset of vague and clear multi-turn requests and a **Python** test harness that checks whether the agent correctly asks or answers, to guide **prompt engineering**; a planned next step is fine-tuning an open-source **Hugging Face** model

Co-Founder/Software Developer — January 2026 – Present
SmartSyllabus, University of Toronto — *Mississauga, ON*

- Co-founded **SmartSyllabus**, an *early-stage* **startup**, building an **AI-powered full-stack web app** with five developers that turns syllabus PDFs into schedules and deadlines (30+ *Flask* endpoints, *React*, *SQLite*)
- Mainly contributed to the **backend** architecture of the app by writing endpoints related to many of its core features like authentication, grade-tracking, and course-management.
- Used **GitHub Projects** in an agile workflow to track task ownership, surface blockers, and coordinate across teammates, ensuring issues were resolved quickly and work was distributed effectively across the team
- Selected for **Ideation Lab**, a competitive experiential learning program hosted by **ICUBE UTM**, the hub for social entrepreneurship and *early-stage startups* in the University of Toronto, Mississauga

Embedded Programmer — September 2022 – April 2023
FIRST Robotics Competition Team 5409, Garth Webb Secondary School — *Oakville, ON*

- Wrote **Java** robot control code with Limelight vision tracking; competed at the **World Championships**, ranking **top 18% globally**

Projects

Radio Calico | *JavaScript, HLS.js, Node.js/Express, Jest, PostgreSQL, Docker, nginx, Claude* April 2026 – Present

- Built a **full-stack web radio player** with live *HLS* audio streaming, now-playing metadata, and per-song ratings using Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, and vanilla JS
- Added **99 Jest tests**, a **multi-stage Docker** build, and a **GitHub Actions CI/CD** pipeline with Trivy, Semgrep, and Gitleaks security scans

Certifications

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — January 2026
Oracle Certified Associate, Java SE 8 Programmer — July 2025

Awards & Achievements

Dean's List Scholar — University of Toronto, Mississauga — June 2024, June 2025

- Awarded for maintaining a cGPA of **3.5** or higher

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C, RISC Assembly
Web, Backend, and Databases: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, Flask, JavaFX, REST APIs, JWT Auth, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Prisma
Tools, Cloud, Testing, and AI: Git, Docker, AWS, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Jest, Trivy, Semgrep, Gitleaks, Claude, Google Gemini